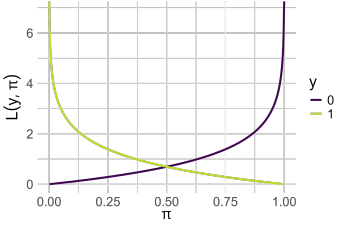
Introduction to Machine Learning

Advanced Risk Minimization
Bernoulli Loss



Learning goals

- Know the Bernoulli loss and related losses (log-loss, logistic loss, Binomial loss)
- Derive the risk minimizer
- Derive the optimal constant model

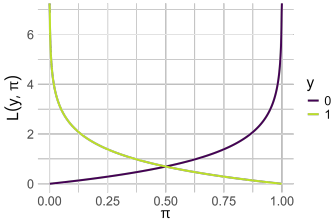
BERNOULLI LOSS ON PROBABILITIES

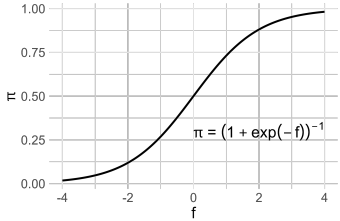
The negative log-likelihood of the Bernoulli distribution is

$$L(y, \pi) = -y \log(\pi) - (1-y) \log(1-\pi) \ , \ y \in \{0, 1\}$$

If probs are transformed into scores as $f = \log\left(\frac{\pi}{1-\pi}\right)$ (log-odds of π), we arrive at another equivalent formulation of the loss:

$$L(y, f) = -y \cdot f + \log(1 + \exp(f)) \quad \text{for } y \in \{0, 1\}$$



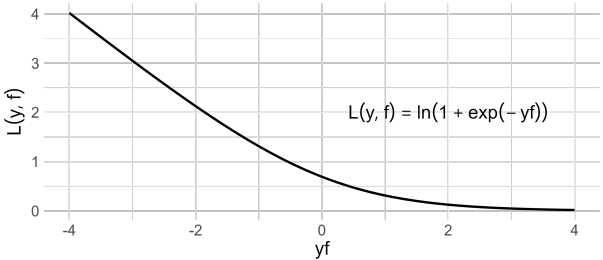


BERNOULLI LOSS LABEL ENCODING

For different label encoding $y' \in \{-1, +1\}$, recognize that $y' = 2y - 1$. Substituting y' into $L(y, f)$ yields

$$L(y, f) = \log(1 + \exp(-y \cdot f)) \quad \text{for } y \in \{-1, +1\}$$

- Two equivalent formulations for different label encodings
- All variants convex, differentiable



BERNOULLI LOSS: RISK MINIMIZER

The risk minimizer for the Bernoulli loss defined for probabilistic classifiers $\pi(\mathbf{x})$ and on $y \in \{0, 1\}$ is

$$\pi^*(\mathbf{x}) = \eta(\mathbf{x}) = \mathbb{P}(y = 1 \mid \mathbf{x} = \mathbf{x}).$$

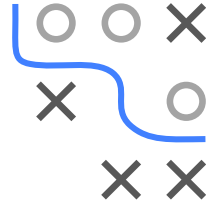
Proof: We can write the risk for binary y as follows:

$$\mathcal{R}(f) \quad = \quad \mathbb{E}_x \left[L(1, \pi(\mathbf{x})) \cdot \eta(\mathbf{x}) + L(0, \pi(\mathbf{x})) \cdot (1 - \eta(\mathbf{x})) \right],$$

with $\eta(\mathbf{x}) = \mathbb{P}(y = 1 \mid \mathbf{x})$ (see section on the 0-1-loss for more details).
For a fixed $\mathbf{x}$ we compute the point-wise optimal value c by setting the derivative to 0:

$$\begin{aligned}
\frac{\partial}{\partial c} \left(-\log c \cdot \eta(\mathbf{x}) - \log(1 - c) \cdot (1 - \eta(\mathbf{x})) \right) &= 0 \\
-\frac{\eta(\mathbf{x})}{c} + \frac{1 - \eta(\mathbf{x})}{1 - c} &= 0 \\
\frac{-\eta(\mathbf{x}) + \eta(\mathbf{x})c + c - \eta(\mathbf{x})c}{c(1 - c)} &= 0 \\
c &= \eta(\mathbf{x}).
\end{aligned}$$

BERNOULLI: OPTIMAL CONSTANT MODEL



The optimal constant probability model $\pi(\mathbf{x}) = \theta$ w.r.t. the Bernoulli loss for labels from $\mathcal{Y} = \{0, 1\}$ is:

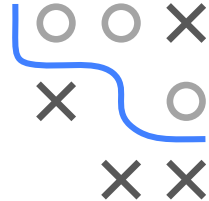
$$\hat{\theta} = \arg\min_{\theta} \mathcal{R}_{\text{emp}}(\boldsymbol{\theta}) = \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^{n} y^{(i)}$$

Again, this is the fraction of class-1 observations in the observed data. We can simply prove this again by setting the derivative of the risk to 0 and solving for θ. The optimal constant score model $f(\mathbf{x}) = \theta$ w.r.t. the Bernoulli loss labels from $\mathcal{Y} = \{-1, +1\}$ or $\mathcal{Y} = \{0, 1\}$ is:

$$\hat{\theta} = \arg\min_{\theta} \mathcal{R}_{\text{emp}}(\boldsymbol{\theta}) = \log \frac{n_+}{n_-} = \log \frac{n_+/n}{n_-/n}$$

where n_- and n_+ are the numbers of negative and positive observations, respectively.
This again shows a tight (and unsurprising) connection of this loss to log-odds.
Proving this is also a (quite simple) exercise.

BERNOULLI-LOSS: NAMING CONVENTION



We have seen three loss functions that are closely related. In the literature, there are different names for the losses:

$$
\begin{aligned}
L(y, f) &= \log(1 + \exp(-yf)) \quad \text{for } y \in \{-1, +1\} \\
L(y, f) &= -y \cdot f + \log(1 + \exp(f)) \quad \text{for } y \in \{0, 1\} \\
L(y, \pi) &= -y \log(\pi) - (1 - y) \log(1 - \pi) \quad \text{for } y \in \{0, 1\} \\
L(y, \pi) &= -\frac{1 + y}{2} \log(\pi) - \frac{1 - y}{2} \log(1 - \pi) \quad \text{for } y \in \{-1, +1\}
\end{aligned}
$$

are equally referred to as Bernoulli, Binomial, logistic, log loss, or cross-entropy (showing equivalence is a simple exercise).